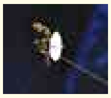
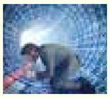
FIRST CONTACT



Everyone with even a little bit of inclination towards science and exploration is curious about whether alien life exists out there. But what if an unknown probe that doesn't belong to us enters our solar system looking for signs of life the same way our Voyager probes are exploring the darkness of space?
http://dgit.in/AlienProbe

DATA CHECKING



We as netizens collectively generate exabytes of data on a continuous basis but actually segregating the useful data from all the useless noise is a huge task. Intelligence agencies the world over rely on complicated algorithms to try and put this data to some use. Here's how it's done:
http://dgit.in/BDataSearch

THE CHIP IN ME

Biohacking involves altering the body by surgically implanting devices inside the human body to improve or add more functions. It's slowly gathering steam as some people are willingly implanting things like RFIDs inside their body. Read this article where a biohacker shares his experience:
http://dgit.in/BioHackExp

WHAT WENT WRONG?

It's the age of startups as some gain a good foothold because of a really strong and growing community, while some just peak early, sputter and die. Quirky which is an invention based startup that brought some really useful ideas to the fore using their closely knit community filed for bankruptcy recently. Head here to learn what went wrong:
http://dgit.in/NotQuirky

UI from the other and allows some phones to operate lag free, while others stumble. Of course, the hardware plays a role, but with the same hardware on two phones, the software is the difference maker.

It's an area where iOS is the undisputed king, and resource management is what let iPhones run at par with or better than any other phone on a mere 1GB of RAM. Of course Apple's vertically integrated system plays a heck of a role here, but let's face it, the company hasn't quite innovated in hardware since the A7 processor.

You might also want to consider Samsung here. Love it or hate it, Touchwiz is much better since the Galaxy Note 4, and that's thanks in no small part to what Samsung has done on the background.

These were just two examples though. There are many other ways that OEMs are trying to make software the real difference maker or differentiator.

SoC is what SoC does

It's not just the OEMs though. Take the Qualcomm Vs. MediaTek battle for example. With its Helio series, MediaTek has a very able SoC to take on Qualcomm's Snapdragons. At the very high end, they may even be evenly matched, which brings us to things like Corepilot. MediaTek's Corepilot algorithm is what can make its upcoming Helio X20 a winner.

Qualcomm also has talked about myriad software enhancements, the newest amongst which is its Smart Protect algorithm. The race is on, and while Qualcomm has the lead, MediaTek is ready to pounce.

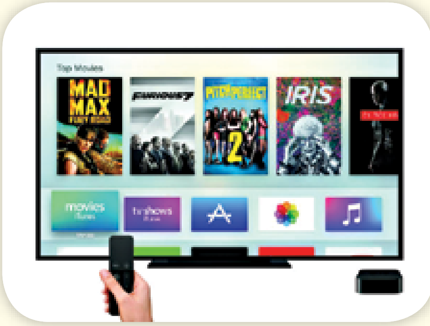
To wearables then

The race to get the best software is perhaps the most important in this arena. When it comes to wearables, especially fitness gadgets, your sensors are exactly the same. This means that the companion app is what makes all the difference. Consider the Fitbit against a Jawbone foe example. It's Jawbone's app that makes me like it more, while they both have exactly the same sensor.

Again, the mere look and feel isn't the sole differentiator here. It's the algorithm thay determines when you're sleeping, when you're standing and so on. The wearables arena is perhaps the most relevant example for hardware saturation and the importance of software.

Let the software games begin

The war is on not just amongst OEMs, but everyone involved in the consumer tech business. Things like Apple TV and Android TV are really dependent on what developers choose to do with them. As revolutionary as Apple makes its TV box look, it's overall interface is almost a replica of Google's Android TV. Having seen Android TV up front on the Sony W950C Android TV, we can expect the same from Apple at the very least.



There's actually only one company that's talking about this at the moment, and that's Motorola. The company repeatedly says its devices are about the experience and not specs. Sadly, stock Android is no longer 'the experience' that gives the best which is what some would argue. Companies like Cyanogen have done well, as have OEMs and their UIs. Which is the reason why Motorola's argument is weak, but it's right in insinuating that software is the immediate future. If you want to make the best phone today you need the best software, period.

http://dgit.in/software-wars